Leave Policy

Purpose and scope

This policy explains how leave works at Northwind Logistics. It applies to all permanent employees in every depot and office.

Contractors and agency staff follow the terms of their own agreements. Questions about this policy can be sent to the People Team.

Eligibility

Full-time employees become eligible for paid annual leave after completing a 3-month probation period. Leave accrues from the first day of employment but cannot be taken during probation without manager approval.

Part-time employees accrue leave pro rata based on their contracted weekly hours.

Annual leave entitlement

Every full-time employee receives 24 working days of paid annual leave per leave year, in addition to public holidays. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December.

Requests for more than 5 consecutive working days must be submitted at least 4 weeks in advance. Managers respond to requests within 3 working days.

Carry forward

Employees may carry forward a maximum of 10 days of unused annual leave into the next leave year. Any days above this limit are forfeited on 31 December.

Carried forward days must be used by 31 March of the following year. Days not used by that date are lost and are not paid out.

Sick leave

Employees receive 12 paid sick days per leave year. A medical certificate is required after 3 consecutive days of absence.

Employees must inform their line manager before the start of their shift on the first day of sickness.

Parental leave

The primary carer receives 16 weeks of parental leave on full pay. The secondary carer receives 4 weeks on full pay.

Parental leave can be taken in one block or in two blocks within 12 months of the birth or adoption.